Part 2

CORS on the server

Part 1 looked at CORS from the perspective of a client making cross-origin requests. Part 2 examines CORS from the perspective of a server receiving a cross-origin request.

Chapter 3 takes a look at how to handle a simple CORS request. It begins by setting up a sample application that will be used throughout the rest of the book. Next, it covers the roles of that the client, the browser, and the server play in a cross-origin request. It then applies this knowledge back to the sample application, and shows how the server uses HTTP response headers to configure CORS behavior. In particular, chapter 3 introduces two key headers used by CORS: the `Origin` request header and the Access-Control-Allow-Origin response header.

Chapter 4 introduces the notion of a preflight request, which allows clients to ask permission before sending a cross-origin request. The preflight request ensures that servers aren't caught off-guard by unexpected requests. The server can give permissions to allow certain HTTP methods (via the Access-Control-Allow-Methods response header) and certain HTTP request headers (via the Access-Control-Allow-Headers response header). Finally, the chapter covers the preflight cache, which allows preflight requests to be cached for a certain period of time.

Chapter 5 rounds out your understanding of CORS by covering two remaining features: including user credentials such as cookies on cross-origin requests, and giving the client permission to view certain response headers.

Chapter 6 takes the knowledge from the previous three chapters and turns it into practical guidance for your own CORS implementation. It starts by looking at the different ways you can allow access to your API, from opening up to the